THE EPISTLE OF PAUL TO

PHILEMON

Salutation. Thanksgiving for Philemon's Love and Fellowship. Onesimus no longer a Servant. Benediction

1 [a]Paul, [b]a prisoner of [c]Christ Jesus, and [d]Timothy [1] our brother, to Philemon our beloved and [e]fellow-worker, 2 and to Apphia [2][f]our sister, and to [g]Archippus our [h]fellow-soldier, and to [i]the church in thy house: 3 [k]Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

4 [l]I thank my God always, [m]making mention of thee in my prayers, 5 [n]hearing of [3]thy love, and of the faith which thou hast toward the Lord Jesus, and toward all the saints; 6 that the fellowship of thy faith may become effectual, in the [o]knowledge of every good thing which is in [4]you, unto Christ. 7 For I had much [p]joy and comfort in thy love, because the hearts of the saints have been [q]refreshed through thee, brother.

8 Wherefore, [r]though I have all boldness in Christ to enjoin thee that which is [s]befitting, 9 yet for love's sake I rather [t]beseech, being such a one as Paul [5]the [u]aged, and now [v]a prisoner also of [c]Christ Jesus: 10 I [t]beseech thee for my [w]child, whom I have begotten in my bonds, [6][y]Onesimus, 11 who once was unprofitable to thee, but now is profitable to thee and to me: 12 whom I have sent back to thee in his own person, that is, my very heart: 13 whom I would fain have kept with me, that in thy behalf he might minister unto me in the [z]bonds of the [7]gospel: 14 but without thy mind I would do nothing; that thy goodness should [a]not be as of necessity, but of free will. 15 For perhaps [b]he was therefore parted *from thee* for a season, that thou shouldest have him for ever; 16 [c]no longer as a [8]servant, but more than a [8]servant, [d]a brother beloved, specially to me, but how much rather to thee, both [e]in the flesh and in the Lord. 17 If then thou countest me a [f]partner, receive him as myself. 18 But if he hath wronged thee at all, or oweth *thee* aught, put that to mine account; 19 [g]I Paul write it with mine own hand, I will repay it: [h]that I say not unto thee that thou owest to me even thine own self besides. 20 Yea, brother, let me have [9]joy of thee in the Lord: [i]refresh my heart in Christ.

21 [k]Having confidence in thine obedience I write unto thee, knowing that thou wilt do even beyond what I say. 22 But withal prepare me also [l]a lodging: for [m]I hope that through [n]your prayers [o]I shall be granted unto you.

23 [p]Epaphras, my [q]fellow-prisoner in [r]Christ Jesus, saluteth thee; 24 *and so do* [s]Mark, [t]Aristarchus, [u]Demas, [u]Luke, my [v]fellow-workers.

25 [z]The grace of [10]our Lord Jesus Christ be [y]with your spirit. [11]Amen.

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[a] See Phil. 1. 1
[b] ver. 9, 23; see Eph. 3. 1
[c] ver. 9, 23; see Gal. 3. 26; 1 Tim. 1. 12
[d] See 2 Cor. 1. 1; Col. 1. 1
[e] ver. 24; see Phil. 2. 25
[f] Rom. 16. 1, &c.
[g] Col. 4. 17
[h] Phil. 2. 25; comp. 2 Tim. 2. 3
[i] See Rom. 16. 5
[k] See Rom. 1. 7
[l] See Rom. 1. 8
[m] Rom. 1. 9
[n] See Eph. 1. 15; Col. 1. 4; comp. 1 Th. 3. 6
[o] Phil. 1. 9, Col. 1. 9; 3. 10
[p] 2 Cor. 7. 4, 13
[q] ver. 20; 1 Cor. 16. 18; 2 Cor. 7. 13
[r] Comp. 2 Cor. 3. 12; 1 Th. 2. 6
[s] Comp. Eph. 5. 4
[t] Rom. 12. 1
[u] Tit. 2. 2
[v] See ver. 1
[w] See 1 Cor. 4. 14 f.
[y] Col. 4. 9
[z] Comp. ver. 10; Phil. 1. 7

[a] 1 Pet. 5. 2; comp. 2 Cor. 9. 7
[b] Comp. Gen. 45. 5, 8
[c] 1 Cor. 7. 22
[d] Mt. 23. 8; 1 Tim. 6. 2
[e] Comp. Eph. 6. 5, Col. 3. 22
[f] 2 Cor. 8. 23; comp. ver. 6
[g] See 1 Cor. 16. 21; comp. 2 Cor. 10. 1; Gal. 5. 2
[h] Comp. 2 Cor. 9. 4
[i] See ver. 7
[k] See 2 Cor. 2. 3
[l] Acts 28. 23
[m] Comp. Phil. 1. 25; 2. 24
[n] See 2 Cor. 1. 11
[o] Comp. Acts 27. 24; Heb. 13. 19
[p] See Col. 1. 7
[q] See Rom. 16. 7; comp. ver. 1
[r] See ver. 1
[s] See Acts 12. 12; Col. 4. 10
[t] See Acts 19. 29; Col. 4. 10
[u] See Col. 4. 14; 2 Tim. 4. 10 f.
[v] See ver. 1
[x] See Gal. 6. 18
[y] Sce 2 Tim. 4. 22

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[1] Gr. *the brother.* [2] Gr. *the sister.*
[3] Or, *thy love and faith*
[4] Many ancient authorities read *us.*
[5] Or, *an ambassador, and now &c.*
[6] The Greek word means *Helpful.* Comp. ver. 20 marg.
[7] Gr. *good tidings.* See marginal note on Mt. 4. 23.
[8] Gr. *bondservant.*
[9] Or, *help* Comp. ver. 10 marg.
[10] Some ancient authorities read *the.*
[11] Many ancient authorities omit *Amen.*